

The Great Prime Minister Bazaar

APRIL 13, 2009

INDIA TODAY's nationwide survey suggests that the 15th General Election is set for the closest-ever finish. With no clear winners, leaders of the smaller parties have as much chance for the top job as the Congress and the BJP.



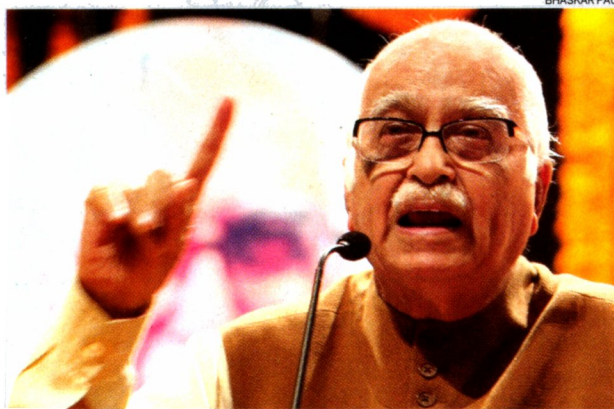
“If some day the concept of PPO (Political Process Outsourcing) comes up, India would be the biggest stakeholder as it has leaders aplenty who claim they will make the best premier.”

RAJNEESH BATRA, via www.indiatoday.in

Too Many Cooks

That so many regional leaders such as Lalu Prasad Yadav, Ram Vilas Paswan, Sharad Pawar, Mayawati and Jayalalithaa are staking their claims for the position of prime minister reflects a bad turn for our democracy. Manmohan Singh or L.K. Advani are the only two leaders with the stature and vision for the nation. It will be a black day for this country if somebody else takes the prime minister's seat.
GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, *Visakhapatnam*

In our country where even the basic political ethics have been martyred, we cannot expect a vox populi government to blossom in the near future.
THARCIOUS S. FERNANDO
Chennai



Money-back Guarantee

The BJP's decision to bring back black money stashed away in Swiss banks is a welcome step ("Minting Political Capital", April 6). With the Congress being uninterested in doing anything on this issue, L.K. Advani's challenge will not only create the right political noise during elections, but also ensure that our national wealth comes back to where it belongs.
K.V. RAGHURAM, via www.indiatoday.in

L.K. Advani has rightly raised the issue, but the Congress would never oblige him and the nation because the Nehru-Gandhi dynasty is the main culprit which has large amounts of money in Swiss banks.
A.K. SHARMA, *Chandigarh*

Two is Best

It is obvious that the Samajwadi Party, the Rashtriya Janata Dal and the Lok Janashakti Party have combined not to dissociate from the Congress but to bargain later from a vantage point ("Till Polls Do Us Apart", March 30). A coalition government remains a bourse for horse-trading, serving only the politicians and not the people. If the voters decide to vote for either of the two major political parties, petty parochial parties will wither away. Parliamentary democracy is best served by a two-party polity.
J.N. BHARTIYA,
Hyderabad

No Comparison

By comparing Varun Gandhi's arrest under the NSA with that of great pa-